Atopic Dermatitis (Eczema)

Everyday steps to protect the skin barrier and reduce flare-ups

ABOUT THIS TOPIC

Atopic dermatitis is a long-term condition that can make skin dry, itchy, and inflamed. It is not contagious. Symptoms can come and go, and a clinician can help distinguish eczema from infections or other rashes.

Everyday care and treatment

- Use a fragrance-free cream or ointment regularly, especially after a short lukewarm bath or shower.
- Use gentle, fragrance-free cleanser only where needed. Pat skin dry instead of rubbing.
- Notice possible personal triggers such as heat, sweat, fragranced products, or rough fabrics; avoid only those that clearly worsen symptoms.
- Follow a clinician-guided plan for flare treatment. Prescription creams and other medicines depend on the person and body area.

WHEN TO GET HELP

Get medical advice for worsening or extensive rash, sleep-disrupting itch, painful cracks, or signs of infection such as increasing warmth, pus, fever, or rapidly spreading redness. Do not use another person's prescription cream.

Sources for further reading

American Academy of Dermatology - Atopic dermatitis treatment - https://www.aad.org/public/diseases/eczema/types/atopic-dermatitis/treatment

Reviewed for this educational handout: October 2026. Recommendations can change and depend on local guidance, age, pregnancy, other health conditions, and medicines. This handout is not a diagnosis or prescription.